Debt and Explainability Journal

William Zhu | The Front Never Stops | GDD production rep

Date as entered: 2026/9/26 | Week/session as entered: Week5

Task attempted: GDD | Tool as entered: ChatGPT6astra | Debt category as entered: Art Design

Authorship note: William's original checklist answers and debt notes are unchanged. The four reflections were supplied by William in Chinese on September 27 and translated into English by AI; the grenade rationale in answer 3 is from his earlier statement. AI supplied no new personal judgments.

Explainability checklist

1 What did it do?

Let chat do a GDD.

2 Why did you use it here?

It is required to do so.

3 What benefits did it provide?

Saves a lot of time, and it might help me organize my thoughts, and rethink about certain MDA.

4 What Prompt Strategies did I use?

I provided all the information and let it handle the work by itself.

5 What risks did it introduce?

May lead to Leak of ideas, the result of the actual prototype might be bad. Lack of creativity, I must say if I am going through the process, new ideas might pop out, but now there is just an ai result.

6 How much time did it cost?

2hours

7 What assumptions were made?

I assume that after providing all the info it would have a moderate amount of output.

8 How did you validate the results?

By checking whether it is actually useable in my game, and whether the plan matches my thoughts.

9 What would you do differently in a real production environment?

No. This should be good enough. I never work with a GDD doc before.

Risk and debt notes

Nothing Technical.

The entire creation is mine, so I don’t think there is a creation problem, but as I said there are no new things poping out.

The design could work, but I probably will make more mehcanics while I work on the engin.

Nothing Legal.

Taste. Should work, but since I need to polish the game, cant say.

Debt category reference

TECHNICAL: Code or systems that work, but nobody fully understands or can maintain.

CREATIVE: Derivative ideas, or overreliance on generated content instead of original vision.

DESIGN: Features added because they were easy to generate, not because they improve the game.

ORGANIZATIONAL: Unclear ownership or communication about who's accountable for an AI-assisted decision.

LEGAL: Ambiguous licensing, ownership, or provenance for anything generated.

TASTE: The gradual erosion of the ability to tell generated content from genuinely good content.

Week 4 reflection questions

William Zhu | Responses supplied September 27 2026 | English translation of William’s own Chinese answers

1 Which section of your GDD would you defend in a greenlight meeting, and which one is still the model's opinion?

At this stage, all the sections seem straightforward, so I feel confident defending all of them.

2 What changed after the red-team pass, and what changed it?

I added playtesting after the red-team review. That was something I had not thought of before.

3 Which AI-suggested feature did you cut, and what player problem did the one you kept solve?

The AI seemed to suggest a timeline, but I did not understand what it was asking for, so I did not follow that suggestion. I did not cut any gameplay features because there were only a few to begin with. I kept scene grenade pickups to give players more room for action.

4 Where did the second model disagree with the first, and which was ultimately right?

Doubao kept focusing on time constraints. I agreed more with GPT because it offered ideas. I may try another model, such as Gemini, to see whether it provides a stronger comparison.